Chapter 1 — A Boy Called Hans Pedersen of Skee (1833–1847)

This chapter follows Hans Pedersen (P18), the father of the emigrant Hans Peter Petersen. Everything here comes from Danish church books and censuses. No family memory reaches back this far.

Born at Valsømagle

Hans Pedersen was born on 25 February 1833 at Valsømagle, a village in Haraldsted parish, Ringsted district, Sorø county, on the island of Zealand (S51, S52, S53). He was baptized in Haraldsted church on 31 March 1833, which was Palm Sunday (S51, S52). The church stood only about 2 miles straight-line from Valsømagle, so the walk from the village to the font was a short one (S51, S53). Valsømagle is still a village today, about 4 miles from Ringsted; the church books give no farm or house for the birth, so the place to stand is the village street itself (S51, S53; map, 55.4933, 11.8213). Haraldsted Kirke still stands on Haraldstedvej in Haraldsted, 4100 Ringsted, with its churchyard — the *kirkegård* — around it (map, 55.4915, 11.7682). It is the same church where he would be confirmed fourteen years later (S51, S52, S56).

The parish clerk entered him as *uægte*, meaning born outside marriage (S51, S52). His mother was an unmarried servant (*pige* / *tjenestepige*) from Valsømagle. Her name was **Ane Marie Hansdatter** (P25; Genealogist locked the patronymic 2026-11-03). The kontraministerialbog copy of the 1833 baptism writes her as **Hansd.**, set interlinear over a struck word (S52). Fourteen years later, at his confirmation, the book again calls her **Ane Marie Hansd.** (S56). The parish move lists around the birth year use the same form and trace her back and forth to Ringsted, in this order. First, Haraldsted's departure list records *Ane Marie Hansd.*, 28, *tjenestepige* (servant girl), leaving for Ringsted; the date is only a ditto mark, read as roughly November 1832 to January 1833 (S60; date LOW). Next, Ringsted's own departure list for 1833 has *Ane Marie Hansdatter*, 28, *tjenestepige*, moving to Haraldsted (S106; a likely but unverified match to her). Then, on 30 March 1833, Haraldsted's arrival list records *Ane Marie Hansd.*, 28, *tjenestepige*, come from Ringsted (S59). This was the day before her son's baptism. About a month later, around 1 May 1833, Haraldsted's departure list records *Ane Marie Hansd.*, 28, *tjenestepige*, leaving the parish again, and the destination is clearly Ringsted (S151; cleared by Alex, Decision 3, 2026-11-03, read with S59). Where she went in Ringsted is not known. No Ringsted arrival entry for her has been found, even though the 1833 arrival list was searched, May–October included (S108, S157). So the trail stops at the Haraldsted departure, and no street or house in Ringsted can be named as the place she arrived. The hovedministerialbog baptism once read as **Clausdatter** (S51); after Alex reviewed the images, that reading was set aside as superseded and Hansdatter was locked. A later eye-read of the same parents cell offered Larsdatter (S276); like Clausdatter, it is a discarded alternate read, not a second name for her. Her parents are still unknown. A birth

date of 23 March 1805 is only a CANDIDATE, not proven. Ringsted town lies roughly 4 miles straight-line from Valsømagle, so the mother's moves and the named father's home both sat within a morning's walk of the child's birthplace (S51, S59, S60).

The same baptism names a man as the child's father. In Danish church books an *udlagt barnefader* is the man the mother named as father; the entry is not proof of paternity. The 1833 Haraldsted baptism writes **Peder Johansen** of Ringsted as that named father (S51). A fresh look at the original page bears this out: the letters of the surname take the shape *Joh-*, not *Jørg-* (S275). A FamilySearch index once read the name as Peder Jørgensen; that reading is a mis-index and has been set aside (S275). The 1847 confirmation repeats the same wording: *Uægte Søn af Pigen Ane Marie Hansd. og udlagt Barnefader Peder Johansen* — illegitimate son of the girl Ane Marie Hansd. and named child's father Peder Johansen — with *pleiefader* (foster father) *Huusm.* Jens Nielsen of Skee (S56). So the record is settled on one point: the mother, Ane Marie Hansdatter, named **Peder Johansen of Ringsted** as the father, and the confirmation lists him again fourteen years later (S51, S52, S56). Genealogist has locked him as Hans's recorded, named father (P34; cleared by Alex 2026-11-03; S51, S52, S56, S275). What the books cannot settle is biology. A named father is not a proven one, no DNA or later record shows that Peder Johansen was in fact the father, and no marriage between Ane Marie and Peder Johansen has been found. The man who raised Hans was his foster father, Jens Nielsen of Skee (S56; P26). The controversy is part of Hans's beginning: the books name a father; the evidence does not close the case.

A year after the baptism, the census of 1834 lets us see the named father for the first time as a living man rather than a name in the margin. In Ringsted town, on the street called Sankt Hans Gade, the census lists **Peter Johansen**, about 30, *ugift* (unmarried), a *tjenestekarl* — a servant, a hired manservant — placed in the household's servants (*Tjenestefolk*) bracket (S64). Genealogist has cleared him as the same man as the Peder Johansen of Ringsted named in the baptism and the confirmation (P34; Alex, Decision B, 2026-11-03; S51, S52, S56, S64). So the father the mother named was, in 1834, an unmarried hired man of about thirty, working in service in Ringsted town, not a farmer or a householder. Sankt Hans Gade is still a street in Ringsted today, now spelled Sct. Hansgade, 4100 Ringsted, and it is the place to stand for Peter Johansen's 1834 residence (map, 55.4445, 11.7908). The census gives no house number, so no particular house is claimed; the street itself is the visit place. That is his place in the world as the records show it. It still does not prove he was the biological father; it tells us who the named man was.

One more clue sits on the same census pages, and it is only a clue. Also listed on Sankt Hans Gade is an **Ane Marie Hansdatter**, 27, unmarried, a *tjenestepige* (maidservant), in another servants' bracket (S63). Her name and age fit Hans's mother, but she is a CANDIDATE match only, not proven to be the same woman (P25). The census does not place her in Peter Johansen's household, and no marriage between Ane Marie and Peder Johansen has been found. The street is pinned here only as Peter Johansen's 1834 residence. Because Ane Marie is only a candidate, this story does not say as fact that the couple lived on the same street, and nothing suggests they

shared a house. The May 1833 departure to Ringsted (S151) also does not prove where the mother lived in town; the two records are separate.

The world he was born into

The records tell us where Hans was born; the encyclopedias tell us what that country looked like. Valsømagle and Haraldsted lay in Sorø county (*Sorø Amt*): in 1798 the old Ringsted county had been merged into it, and only a few years after Hans's birth, in 1837 and 1841, the parishes and market towns were made into local municipalities of their own (K1)(K2). Ringsted, about 4 miles from Valsømagle, was the market town for the parishes around it (K2).

Haraldsted itself was an old place even then. In the Middle Ages it had been a royal estate and a pilgrimage village, because Duke Knud Lavard was murdered in the nearby forest in 1131 (K4) (K5). The parsonage that still stands southeast of the church — the *præstegård* named in Chapter 1's 1797 betrothal — is a thatched, half-timbered four-wing house rebuilt after a fire in 1789, so it was barely forty years old when Hans was baptized (K6; S222). The sources do not say that Hans or his mother ever went inside it.

The countryside had been remade within living memory. The villages of the Ringsted district were enclosed — the old shared fields split into separate holdings — in roughly 1780–1810; some farms stayed in the village and others moved out onto their own land (K1). Farms dominated this district, and cottagers (*husmænd*) were few compared with farmers (K1)(K11). Those are district-wide statements; how many farms and houses Valsømagle or Skee had in 1833 is not in the sources used here.

Denmark in 1833 was still an absolute monarchy: the king ruled without a parliament, and would until the June Constitution of 1849 (K15). The old *stavnsbånd*, which had tied peasant men to the estate where they were born, had been abolished in 1788, some forty-five years before Hans was born (K18). The 1814 school ordinances had made schooling compulsory for ordinary children (K20); which school served Skee or Valsømagle, and whether Hans attended it, is UNVERIFIED and not found in the records.

A foster son in Skee

Hans did not grow up with his mother. On the census of 18 February 1834, when he was one year old, he was living in the village of Skee in Haraldsted parish, about 3 miles straight-line from Valsømagle where he was born and about 3 miles from Haraldsted church. He was listed as a *pleiebarn* (foster child) in the household of Jens Nielsen, a cottager (*husmand*) and wheelwright, and his wife Kirsten Johansdatter (S54).

Those foster parents had married long before Hans was born. On 30 October 1818, in Særløse Kirke, bachelor Jens Nielsen, then 26 and *tjenende* (serving) near Lejre, married Kirsten Johansdatter, then 22 and *tjenende hos gårdmand* (serving in a farmer's household) at Tølstrup

(S310). The marriage entry names no parents for either of them. Genealogist has cleared this couple as Hans's verified foster parents (P26 and P27). Nothing in that record — or elsewhere cleared so far — shows that Jens or Kirsten were kin to Ane Marie Hansdatter or to the named father Peder Johansen; that kinship stays unverified (S310).

He was still there at the next two censuses:

- **1 February 1840:** "Hans Pedersen, 6, unmarried, foster child" in the household of Jens Nielsen, 49, and Kirsten, 44 (S55).
- **1 February 1845:** "Hans Pedersen, 12," born in the parish, now called a *pleiesøn* (foster son) (S57).

So from his first year until at least age twelve, the cottage of Jens and Kirsten in Skee was his home (S54, S55, S57, S310). No cleared record shows that the foster parents were related to him, to his mother, or to Peder Johansen.

The records show that Jens Nielsen worked as a wheelwright (S54). Many years later, Hans himself would be a wheelwright, a *hjulmand* (S36, S37). The sources do not say who taught him the trade. We can only note that he grew up in a wheelwright's home, and that by 1850 Jens Nielsen was still entered as *huusmand* and, in a hard-to-read word, perhaps *hjulmager* (S58). The thread of the trade runs unbroken from the foster father's cottage to Hans's own marriage entry fifteen years later (S36).

Confirmation, 1847

On 11 April 1847, the first Sunday after Easter, Hans was confirmed in Haraldsted church. Confirmation was not optional: it had been compulsory in Denmark since 1736, and it required the young person to pass a test of what they had learned (K19). He was entered as boy no. 3: "Hans Pedersen of Skee," born 25 February 1833 at Valsømagle and vaccinated 29 June 1833 by Aschlund (S56). The full confirmation line is the richest single sentence we have for his childhood: *Hans Pedersen af Skee … Uægte Søn af Pigen Ane Marie Hansd. og udlagt Barnefader Peder Johansen — Pleiefader Huusm. Jens Nielsen i Skee* (S56). In one entry the parish records his foster home in Skee, his mother as Hansd., and the named father from Ringsted, whose biological fatherhood is still unproven. Folio 41, no. 1026, is the book's own reference for that confirmation (S56). A visitor today can walk the churchyard that surrounds Haraldsted church — the ground he crossed on his baptism day and again at fourteen (S51, S56).

A betrothal at the parsonage, 1797 (CANDIDATE)

One older record may reach back toward Ane Marie's own family, but it is not proven. On 21 May 1797, at Haraldsted Præstegaarden — the parish parsonage — the widower (*enkemand*) Hans Pedersen and the girl (*pige*) Maren Hansdatter, written *Maren Hans D.*, both of Walsøemagle (Valsømagle), were betrothed, *trolovede* (S222). They were married on 15 October 1797 (S222).

The betrothal and the place are clear in the record. Whether this couple were Ane Marie's parents is **Provisional — a CANDIDATE only**: a daughter named Hansdatter from the same village would fit, but her own baptism has not been found, so nothing ties her to them yet (S222; P25). Even the bride's name leans Maren rather than Marie, but that too is still being checked.

The parsonage still stands about 80 metres southeast of Haraldsted church, at Haraldstedvej 91 (map, 55.4910, 11.7692). It is a working private home and parish office today, so the place to stand is the road or the churchyard side, not the grounds. The record does not say in which room the couple stood, and this story does not guess.

What we do not know yet

- Whether **Peder Johansen** of Ringsted was Hans's biological father remains open. He is locked as the recorded, *named* father (P34; S51, S52, S56, S275) and, by Decision B, as the 1834 Sankt Hans Gade *tjenestekarl* (S64); biological paternity is not proven, and no marriage to Ane Marie has been found.
- Where Ane Marie Hansdatter went in Ringsted after she left Haraldsted around 1 May 1833 is still open. No Ringsted arrival entry has been found (S151; S108, S157 negative).
- Who Ane Marie Hansdatter's parents were, and when exactly she was born, is still open. Her patronymic is locked as Hansdatter (P25), but 23 March 1805 is only a CANDIDATE birth date. A Valsømagle couple, Hans Pedersen and Maren Hansdatter, betrothed at the Haraldsted parsonage in 1797 (S222), are a CANDIDATE pair for her parents only — her baptism is missing, and they are not locked as her parents.
- Whether the Ane Marie Hansdatter, 27, *tjenestepige*, on Sankt Hans Gade in 1834 (S63) is Hans's mother is not proven; she is a CANDIDATE match for P25 only, and the census does not place her in Peter Johansen's household.
- Whether foster parents Jens Nielsen and Kirsten Johansdatter (married 30 Oct 1818 at Særløse Kirke, S310) were kin to Ane Marie Hansdatter or to Peder Johansen remains unverified; Dig J clears only the marriage for P26/P27 as foster parents, not blood kinship.
- At the census of 1 February 1850 Hans, then about 17, was no longer in the Skee foster household (S58). Where he was living that year has not been found.
- The years between 1850 and 1862 are blank in our records. The next time we see him, he is a young man working at Bjernedegaard in Bjernede parish (Chapter 2).

Chapter 2 — Bjernede: A Marriage, Four Children, and Loss (1862–1884)

This chapter covers Hans Pedersen (P18) and Ane Rasmusdatter (P19), their sons, and the second family Ane started after she was widowed. The facts come from the Bjernede church books, Danish censuses, and a 1884 property deed. These people are documented in records, but

the family did not hand down their names. Alex has confirmed the birthplace (Bjernede) and the birth year (1864) of Hans Peter (S30).

The wedding, 14 October 1862

On 14 October 1862, Hans Pedersen married Ane Rasmusdatter in Bjernede church in Sorø county (S36). The register calls him a bachelor (*ungkarl*) and a wheelwright (*hjulmand*), born 25 February 1833 at a place the clerk wrote as something like "Walsmagle" — Valsømagle, about 8 miles straight-line from Bjernede (S36, S51). It calls her a maiden (*pige*), born 17 June 1843 (S36). Her birthplace was entered as what may read "Bjernede Lodsgaard," but that reading is uncertain (S36). Her parents have not yet been found. Bjernede church, where they married, lies about 6 miles straight-line from Haraldsted church, where Hans had been baptized and confirmed (S36, S56). Bjernede Kirke still stands at Bjernede Kirkevej 1A, 4180 Sorø — Zealand's only surviving round church, about 5 km (3 miles) northeast of Sorø, built probably in the 1160s–70s by Sune Ebbesen of the Hvide family (K8)(K9; map pin from Places Scout) (map, 55.4621, 11.6251). The same building saw this wedding, Hans Peter's baptism and confirmation, and the burials of his baby brother and his father (S31, S32, S36, S37, S41).

The Denmark of their wedding

Hans and Ane married in a different Denmark from the one Hans had been born into. Under the June Constitution of 5 June 1849 the king gave up absolute power and a parliament, the Rigsdag, was created. Men over 30 with their own household could vote, except people convicted of crimes and people on poor relief (K15). The records do not say whether Hans ever voted.

The railway had come, too. In 1856 the western line from Roskilde was extended to Korsør, and Ringsted, Fjenneslev, and Sorø all got stations that year — about six years before the wedding and about ten before Hans Peter's birth (K2)(K22). Nothing in the records says the family ever rode it.

Many houses in the Danish countryside had been built during the enclosure years and often stood together in cottager colonies (*husmandskolonier*) at the edge of the village fields; few new ones were built after 1810 (K11)(K24). The family's place name, *Bjernedegaardshuse* — "the Bjernedegaard houses" — sounds like such a cluster, but whether it was one is UNVERIFIED. What the records do say is Hans's trade: he was a wheelwright, *hjulmand*, at his wedding, at Rasmus's baptism, and at his burial (S36, S43, S37).

A first son who lived one day

Their first child was a boy, born 17 January 1863. The register labels him "1st child" (S42). He died the next day, 18 January, and the entry seems to say he died unbaptized, so he never received a name (S42).

Hans Peter, 1864

Their second son was born on 28 February 1864 and baptized in Bjernede on 5 June 1864 as **Hans Peder Pedersen**, son of Hans Pedersen and Ane Rasmusdatter (S31). He is the man who later became Hans Peter Petersen of Redwood County, Minnesota. Alex has confirmed that this is "our Hans" (S30).

He was born into a war year. Denmark's war with Prussia and Austria over Schleswig began around the start of February 1864 (exact start date UNVERIFIED in the sources used here) (K23). On 18 April 1864 the Dybbøl position was stormed — more than 35,000 Prussian troops against about 10,000 Danes — and the Danes fell back to Als (K23). By the Peace of Vienna, later that year (treaty date UNVERIFIED here), Denmark gave up the duchies (K23). So the whole war ran through Hans Peter's first months, between his birth on 28 February and well after his baptism on 5 June (S31, K23). No record says that his father or any man of Bjernede served, and how the war was felt in Sorø county is not known from the sources used here.

Rasmus, winter 1866–67

A third son, Rasmus Pedersen, was born on 10 December 1866 at Bjernedegaardshuse and baptized in church on 23 January 1867. The register gives his father's trade as wheelwright (S43). Rasmus died on 5 February 1867 and was buried on 10 February (S41, S43). The dates put him at about eight weeks old, but the burial entry's age column seems to read "12 Dage" (12 days), a reading marked uncertain (S41). The two books do not agree, and this story leaves the discrepancy open.

Hans Pedersen's death, September 1867

Seven months later, the father died too. Hans Pedersen, wheelwright of Bjernedegaardshuse, died on 11 September 1867 and was buried at Bjernede on 17 September. He was 34 (S37). The burial entry calls him "Søn af Ane Marie Hans Dat.(?)", another Hansdatter-style reading of his mother's name (S37; see Chapter 1). Hans Peter was three and a half when his father was laid in Bjernede churchyard (S31, S37). Baby Rasmus had been buried in this churchyard seven months earlier (S41). No grave from 1867 is known to survive; the family can stand in the churchyard where both were buried, not at a marked grave. The cause of death in the register is too hard to read, so this chapter leaves it out.

Bjernedegaardshuse, Bjernedehuse, Bjernede

The books name the family's places in three overlapping ways: *Bjernedegaardshuse* (the houses belonging to Bjernedegaard) for Rasmus's birth and his father's death in 1866–67 (S37, S43), *Bjernedehuse* for the half-siblings' births in 1871 and 1874 (S39, S47, S48), and plain *Bjernede* in the censuses (S44, S33). All of it lies within about a mile of Bjernede church. Which house the

family lived in has not been proven. A visitor can walk among the houses of Bjernede, for example near the Stokholtsvej area about a kilometre east-southeast of the church, but no single house can be named as theirs.

A widow and her boy, 1870

On the census of 1 February 1870, Ane appears as "Anne Rasmusen," 27, a widow. She is living in a house in Bjernede with her son "Hans Peter Pedersen, 6" (S44).

A second marriage and a second family

In spring 1870, Ane married Hans Rasmussen in Bjernede. The day of the wedding cannot be read (S38). He was a widower marrying for the third time, and this was her second marriage (S38). The death record of Hans Rasmussen gives his age as 83 in 1883 (S46), so he was much older than Ane. His birth year is given differently in different records (S38, S46).

Hans Peter gained two half-siblings:

- **Rasmus Peter Rasmussen**, born 1 March 1871 at Bjernedehuse and baptized 4 April 1871 (S39, S47).
- **Ane Marie Rasmussen**, born 24 October 1874 at Bjernedehuse. Her baptism is recorded as 10 January 1875 in one book (S40) and 11 January 1875 in another (S48).

Hans Peter's confirmation and the 1880 census

Hans Peter was confirmed in Bjernede on Palm Sunday, 14 April 1878. His parents were entered as *boelsmand* (smallholder) Hans Petersen and Ane Rasmusdatter, and his birth date as 28 February 1864 (S32).

On the census of 1 February 1880, a "Hans Peder Pedersen, 15," appears as a stepson in the household of Hans Rasmussen and Ane Rasmussen in Bjernede (S33). Parts of this entry are hard to read.

1883: the household ends

Hans Rasmussen, a smallholder (*bolmand*) of Bjernede Huse, died in early July 1883, about the 2nd, and was buried a few days later. The exact days are hard to read (S46). His father is named as Rasmus Hansen (S46).

Three days or so earlier, on 29 June 1883, an "Ane Marie Rasmussen," age 40 and the wife in her second marriage of smallholder Hans Rasmussen of Bjerne Huse, died. She was buried on 5 July 1883 (S45). **Provisional:** she is very likely Ane Rasmusdatter, because the husband, age, and second marriage all match. But the entry calls her "Ane Marie" and does not name her parents, so

the identification is an inference (S45). What is certain is that the confirmation records of both younger children say that both parents were dead (S47, S48).

The estate of matr. 5a, 1884

Hans Rasmussen had owned a property in Bjernede parish recorded as **matr. no. 5 A af Bjernedehuse** (S50). On 13 November 1884, his estate and that of his late wife sold it to J.P. Mathiesen, a miller of Gyrstinge, for 13,000 kroner (S50). Gyrstinge lies about 3 miles straight-line from Bjernede. It was one of the bigger villages of the Ringsted district, with 24 farms, and unlike most of its neighbours it had belonged to Sorø Klosters Len after 1536 (K1). The deed also required the buyer to honor an existing lease to *Indsidder* (lodger) Hans Andersen, running from 12 December 1867 (S50). The deed describes the property as having "hitherto belonged" to Hans Rasmussen (S50). Hans Pedersen did not own it (S50), and whether young Hans Peter ever lived on 5a is not proven. A mortgage bond of 3,600 kroner was recorded as owed to "the minors Rasmus Peter and Ane Marie Rasmussen," children of the late Hans Rasmussen and his wife (S50).

The orphaned half-siblings went to foster homes:

- At his spring 1885 confirmation, Rasmus Peter's foster father was farmer Rasmus Rasmussen, of a place read as Fuldby (S47).
- At her autumn 1888 confirmation, Ane Marie's foster father was smallholder Anders Larsen of Bjernedehuse (S48).

Hans Peter was 20 by the time of the sale and does not appear on the deed (S50). By then he had already left Denmark (Chapter 3, S83).

What we do not know yet

- Ane Rasmusdatter's parents and her baptism.
- The cause of Hans Pedersen's death.
- Rasmus's age at death: about eight weeks by the dates, "12 Dage"(?) in the burial entry (S41, S43).
- Whether Ane Marie Rasmussen of 1883 is Ane Rasmusdatter (Provisional, S45, S50).
- Which house in Bjernedehuse was Hans Peter's childhood home.
- Who Hans Rasmussen's first two wives were.
- What happened to Ane Marie Rasmussen after 1888.

Chapter 3 — Hans Peter Crosses to Minnesota (1884–1922)

This chapter covers Hans Peter Petersen (P6) and Maren Sophia Jensen (P7). It draws on Danish emigration and church records, US censuses, Minnesota death records, and Find a Grave. Find a Grave is a secondary source. Michael Don Petersen has confirmed that Hans Peter and Maren Sophia were Elmer's parents.

Leaving through Copenhagen, April 1884

On 16 April 1884, the Copenhagen Police emigration register recorded "Hans Peter Petersen" of Bjernede, Sorø, age 20, occupation entered as *Tjenende(?)* — in service, a hired servant (medium-confidence reading), heading for Springfield, Minn., under contract no. 1015 Y, with no companions listed on that contract (S83; earlier index summary S34). The register does not say why he left, and this story does not guess. Every later American census agrees that he came in 1884 (S27, S28).

He was about two months past his twentieth birthday (S31, S34). His father had died when he was three (S37). At the time he left, his mother and stepfather were already gone (S45, S46), but the 1884 sale of his stepfather's property was still months away (S50).

Registration took place in Copenhagen, about 40 miles straight-line from Bjernede (S83). The register does not name a ship, a pier, or a route (S83). Springfield, the town he named as his destination, lies about 22 miles straight-line from Redwood Falls, the county seat of Redwood County, where he would farm. Morgan, the town whose newspaper later reported his death, is about 13 miles from Springfield (S83, S145). The records do not show how he travelled from his US arrival to Redwood County.

Marriage to Maren Sophia Jensen, 11 March 1891

Hans Peter's wife was Maren Sophia Jensen. She was born in November 1872 (S13, S27). The censuses disagree on where: the 1900 and 1910 censuses say Minnesota (S27, S28), but the 1920 census says Denmark (S29). Find a Grave also says Minnesota (S13). The records lean two to one toward Minnesota, but this story leaves the question open. Her parents were Nels Peter Jensen and Anne Marie Hansen Jensen (S13). On 11 March 1891, Hans Peter and Mary S. Jensen were married at Redwood Falls, the county seat of Redwood County, Minnesota (S272). The original marriage record survives in the Redwood County marriage book and has been viewed (S272). On the affidavit his name is written "Hans Peter Petersen"; the license on the same form spells it "Hans P. Peterson" (S272). "Mary S." is the same woman this story calls Maren Sophia; the 1900 census also lists her as "Mary" (S27, S272). Two witnesses signed: Niels Jensen and J. L. Byram (S272). The record does not say how either witness was related to the couple, if at all, and it gives

no ages or parents, so this story says nothing more about them or about the ceremony itself (S272). The date fits the 1910 census, which says the couple had been married 19 years (S28).

The farm in Brookville Township

The censuses place the family in Brookville Township, and in 1910 and 1920 they owned their farm (S27–S29, S271). Where in the township that farm stood has not been found, so this story names only the township where they farmed, not the farm itself.

1900. On 19 June 1900, the census taker for Brookville Township, Redwood County, listed the "Hans Peterson" household (S27). Hans was born in February 1864 in Denmark. He had come in 1884, had been in the US 16 years, and had taken the first step toward citizenship (marked "Na"). His occupation was farmer (S27). His wife was listed as "Mary," and the children were Nels A. (born October 1891), Hans O. (May 1893), Annie H. (January 1895), Louis C. (October 1896), and Mary S. (May 1898) (S27).

1905. The 1905 Minnesota state census found Hans P. Petersen, 41, born in 1864 in Denmark, still in Brookville Township (S273). With him were Maren S., 32, and three children: Niels A. 13, Hans R. 12, and Anna H. 10 (S273). The "Hans R." of 1905 may be the same boy as the 1900 "Hans O." and the 1910 "Rudolph H.", but that is not proven; this story gives the name exactly as the census wrote it (S27, S28, S273).

1910. On 23 April 1910, the family was still in Brookville Township. Hans P., 45, was a farmer who **owned his farm** (S28). Maren S., 37, born in Minnesota, was recorded as the mother of seven children, all seven living (S28). The children at home were Rudolph H. 16, Anna H. 15, Louis C. 13, Marie E. 11, Ethel M. 8, and Elmer H. 4 (S28).

1920. In January 1920, Hans P., 55, born in Denmark with Danish as his mother tongue, still **owned his farm** in Brookville Township, though the census marked it **mortgaged** — the farm was his, but there was still a loan on it (S29, S271). It was now a **dairy farm**, and he worked it for himself, not for wages (S29, S271). The same census says he came in 1884 and was **naturalized in 1897** — by then a citizen of his new country (S271). At home were Maren S., 47, and Anna H. 25, Ethel M. 17, Elmer H. 13, and Olga M. 8 (S29). This census gives Maren's birthplace as Denmark, but the 1900 and 1910 censuses both say Minnesota (S27, S28, S29); see above.

The children

The children named in the records are:

- **Nels A.**, born October 1891 (S27)
- **Annie (Anna) H.**, born January 1895 (S27, S28, S29)
- **Louis C.**, born October 1896 (S27, S28)
- **Mary S.**, born May 1898 (S27). The 1910 census lists a daughter "Marie E.," 11 (S28).

- **Rudolph H. Petersen**, born 8 May 1893 in Minnesota; mother Jensen; died 13 April 1964 in Hennepin County (S95). He appears as "Rudolph H.," 16, in 1910 (S28). The 1900 census lists a son "Hans O.," born May 1893 (S27); Genealogist treats that as the same boy, because the birth month and year match Rudolph's MNHS dates (S95). No record yet explains the change from Hans O. to Rudolph H., so the match rests on the dates.
- **Ethel Mathilda Petersen**, born 15 January 1902 in Brookville Township (S92, S152); married Werner Jensen 3 January 1923; died 20 October 1929 (S152). She appears as Ethel M., 8, in 1910 (S28).
- **Elmer Hamilton Petersen**, born 24 March 1906 in Redwood County. The Minnesota birth index registers him as "Babe" Petersen, mother Jensen (S94); later records use Elmer (S14, S15, S28). He is our line (Chapter 4).
- **Olga Margaret Petersen**, born 28 February 1911 in Redwood County; mother Jensen (S93). She appears as Olga M., 8, in 1920 (S29). Death year 1935 is still from Find a Grave only (S15).

Altogether, seven children were living in 1910 (S28), and Olga was born afterward (S93, S29), for eight children.

Hans Peter's death

In September 1922 the *Redwood Gazette* reprinted a Morgan Messenger notice: Hans P. Petersen, age 55, of Brookville Township about two miles east of the Brookville church, died suddenly about 4:30 in the afternoon of heart trouble and complications while sitting in a chair. He had been ailing for some time; funeral arrangements were not yet made. He was survived by his wife and several children, unnamed in the notice (S145).

The records do not quite agree on his name. The newspaper calls him **Hans P.** Petersen (S145). A Minnesota death index — the FamilySearch copy of the Minnesota Historical Society index — lists a **Hans T.** Petersen who died 6 September 1922 in Redwood County, certificate 011514 (S274). Alex has noted that the "T." may be a typo in the index, but the death certificate itself has not been seen, so the difference stays open (S145, S274). This story calls him Hans P. / Hans Peter, the name Alex has chosen to use. The date 6 September 1922 also stays a candidate only; the newspaper alone does not prove the calendar day (S145, S274).

He is buried at Dannebod Cemetery in Brookville Township, Redwood County (S12). The cemetery dates from 1876 and was the burial ground of the Danish Fredsminde church, built in 1889 (S20). The wording on his stone has not yet been transcribed. The burial itself comes from Find a Grave, a secondary source, so it is held at medium confidence (S12). The cemetery is easy to find: on 180th Street just west of Skyview Avenue, near Cobden, with a historical marker on the north side of the road and the Fredsminde church monument behind it, where the church stood from 1889 to 1961 (map, 44.31115, -94.89040).

Find a Grave places Maren Sophia's death in 1937 and her burial at Dannebod (S13). A Minnesota Historical Society death confirmation for that year was not approved in Genealogist's MN Pack #5, so the 1937 date and the Dannebod burial both stay secondary (Find a Grave) for now (S13).

Chapter 4 — From Elmer to Alex (1906–present)

This chapter carries the line from the Minnesota farm to today. It uses Minnesota death indexes, Find a Grave (secondary), obituaries, and family testimony. Living members of the current household are left out on purpose.

Elmer Hamilton Petersen and Caroline Schultz

Elmer Hamilton Petersen was born on 24 March 1906 in Redwood County. He was the son of Hans Peter Petersen and Maren Sophia Jensen (S14, S15). The Minnesota death index lists his mother's maiden name as Jensen (S14). He appears as Elmer H., age 4, in 1910 and age 13 in 1920, on his father's Brookville Township farm (S28, S29).

His Minnesota birth index entry records him as "Babe" Petersen, mother Jensen, on the same date (S94); later records call him Elmer (S14, S28).

His wife was Caroline Alvina Minnie Schultz, born on 21 March 1908 in Sundown Township, another township of Redwood County (S16). Her death record lists her mother's maiden name as Geske (S17). Their son Donald's record lists Donald's mother's maiden name as Schultz (S19). Find a Grave gives 1931 as the year Elmer and Caroline married (S15, S16). No marriage record has been found yet.

They had two sons, Darvin and Donald (S15, S18, S19).

Darvin Wayne Petersen was born on 28 March 1932 in rural Evan, Minnesota (S278). Evan is a small village in neighboring Brown County (map, 44.3540, -94.8410); the exact farm where he was born has not been identified (places/evan-mn-rural.md). He served in the US Air Force during the Korean War and went on to a career in aviation (S278). A veterans' burial listing gives his rank as first lieutenant; his obituary does not mention it, so that detail is less certain (S279). On 27 June 1954 he married Anna Maye Hansen at Bethany Lutheran Church in Morgan (S278, S280). The church stands at 27220 County Highway 13 (map, 44.4452, -94.9873) (places/bethany-lutheran-morgan.md). Anna Maye was born on 3 October 1933 in rural Morgan (S280). They raised five children: Dwight, Daniel, Diana, Douglas, and Deborah (S281). Darvin died on 29 June 2007 in Wolfeboro, New Hampshire (map, 43.5848, -71.2122; where in town is not known; places/wolfeboro-nh.md), survived by his wife and all five children; his only brother, Donald, had died before him (S278). He was brought home and buried in Bethany Lutheran Church Cemetery in Morgan, where his parents rest (S278, S279, S287). The cemetery is the churchyard on the same grounds as the church pinned above; that it shares the church campus is well supported but not

yet checked against a cemetery GPS point, and the row of his grave has not been pinned (places/bethany-lutheran-morgan.md). Anna Maye died on 10 May 2014 in Pownal, Cumberland County, Maine (map, 43.8923, -70.1835; town only, where in town is not known) (S280, S288; places/pownal-me.md), and was buried in the same Bethany Lutheran Church Cemetery (S288); her grave row is likewise not pinned (places/bethany-lutheran-morgan.md).

Elmer died on 24 October 1964 in Redwood County (S14, S15). Caroline died on 8 August 1984 (S16, S17). They share plot North 9 in Bethany Lutheran Church Cemetery in Morgan (S15, S16), about 13 miles straight-line from Redwood Falls.

Donald Alvin Petersen and Janice Elaine Dohrmann

Donald Alvin Petersen was born on 23 July 1935 in Redwood County (S18, S19). He served in the US Army from 15 March 1955 to 14 March 1957, with the 82nd Airborne (S1, S2). His gravestone reads "SP 3 US ARMY" (S18).

Janice Elaine Dohrmann was born on 23 July 1938 in Sleepy Eye, Minnesota (map, 44.2972, -94.7242; town only — the birth house has not been pinned) (S1, S2, S148, S149, S301; places/sleepy-eye-mn.md), to Wesley Edward Dohrmann and Ethel Bertha (Neubauer) Dohrmann (S1, S2, S148, S149). Ethel was born 27 November 1911 in Brown County and died 7 June 1994 in Brown County; her mother's maiden name was Gent (S148, S149). She and Wesley, who married in 1935, rest in Home Cemetery in Sleepy Eye (S89, S150). A Find a Grave bio for Wesley that says he married "Ethel Gent" misstates Ethel's maiden name (S89). Both readings are on record: the Find a Grave bio says Gent; the Minnesota birth and death indexes say Neubauer, with Gent as her mother's maiden name (S148, S149). The indexes settle it. She and Donald married on 14 September 1957 in Brown County, Minnesota (S300). Her obituaries place the ceremony at the Methodist church in Sleepy Eye — today's Faith United Methodist Church at 321 1st Ave S (map, 44.2944, -94.7225); the building is well identified, but that the 1957 service used this same lot is not proven from a register (S1, S2, S301; places/sleepy-eye-methodist.md). Her obituary says they farmed in Paxton Township as the second generation on the family farm (S1). Paxton Township is a township of Redwood County. For scale, Sleepy Eye, where they married, lies about 26 miles straight-line from Redwood Falls and about 13 miles from Morgan.

Their first son, Randy Don, was born on 30 July 1958 and died on 18 October 1958 in Redwood County, not yet three months old (S18, S283, S290). He was buried in Redwood Falls Cemetery, where his stone reads "2 1/2 Months" (S289). The cemetery lies off North Swain Street on the north side of Redwood Falls (map, 44.5510, -95.1000); where in the cemetery his small stone stands has not been pinned (places/redwood-falls-cemetery.md). Four more sons followed: Rick, **Michael Don Petersen**, Chad, and Bill (S282). Michael was born on 5 August 1961 (S0, S2). Donald and Janice had five sons in all (S282).

Donald died on 13 June 1980 at age 44 and is buried in Redwood Falls Cemetery (S18, S19). On 28 June 1986 Janice married Loren Jacobsen (S301). She died on 18 April 2025 at Vista Prairie at

Garnette Gardens, 511 South DeKalb Street in Redwood Falls (map, 44.5356, -95.0981) — an active care facility, pinned as her death place only (S301; places/garnette-gardens-redwood-falls.md). She was buried in Redwood Falls Cemetery, the same grounds pinned above for Randy and Donald; cemetery-level burial is well supported, but no Find a Grave memorial for her has been found, so no individual grave pin is given (S301, S302; places/redwood-falls-cemetery.md). Her obituary lists her four living sons as of 2025: Rick (Kim) and Mike (Mary) of Redwood Falls, Chad (Heather) of River Falls, Wisconsin, and Bill (Kimberlee) of Hutchinson, Minnesota (S282).

Michael and Alex

Michael Don Petersen is Alex Petersen's father (S0). Michael confirmed the family link back to Hans Peter Petersen and Maren Sophia Jensen (S0). Alex then matched the Danish records to "our Hans" (S30).

That is where this first telling of the story ends: with Alex, five generations after a twenty-year-old from Bjernede gave his name to the Copenhagen police and set out for America (S83).

Source key (only sources cited in chapters; text from ../../sources.md)

- S0: Alex Petersen, personal communication, 2026-11-02 (oral; leads only)
- S1: Stephens Funeral Service obituary, Janice E. Jacobsen (1938–2025): https://stephensfuneralservice.com/obituaries/janice-e-jacobsen/779/
- S2: Marshall Radio obituary, Janice Jacobsen: https://marshallradio.net/janice-jacobsen/
- S3: Marshall Independent obituary, 22 Apr 2025: https://www.marshallindependent.com/obituaries/2025/04/janice-jacobsen/
- S4: KLGR obituary: https://www.myklgr.com/obituaries/janice-e-jacobsen/
- S12: Find a Grave, Hans Petersen (1864–1922), Dannebod Cemetery: https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/148703470/hans-petersen (secondary; 3 photos — stone photo not yet transcribed; read via browser pass 2026-11-02)
- S13: Find a Grave, Maren Sophia Jensen Petersen (Nov 1872 MN–1937): https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/148703453/maren_sophia-petersen (secondary)
- S14: MNHS People Records, Minnesota death cert index, Elmer H. Petersen, 1964-MN-016272 (mother JENSEN): https://www.mnhs.org/search/people
- S15: Find a Grave, Elmer Hamilton Petersen: https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/54664129/elmer-hamilton-petersen (secondary)
- S16: Find a Grave, Caroline Alvina Minnie Schultz Petersen: https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/54664126/caroline-alvina_minnie-petersen (secondary)
- S17: MNHS death cert index, Caroline Alvina Minnie Petersen, 1984-MN-021408 (mother GESKE)

- S18: Find a Grave, Donald Alvin Petersen: https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/191558268/donald-alvin-petersen (stone "SP 3 US ARMY"; 2 photos)
- S19: MNHS death cert index, Donald Alvin Petersen, 1980-MN-015396 (mother SCHULTZ)
- S20: HMDB, Dannebod Historical Marker (cemetery est. 1876, Fredsminde Danish church 1889, Brookville Twp near Cobden): https://www.hmdb.org/m.asp?m=257655
- S27: 1900 US Census, Brookville Twp, Redwood Co MN, ED 232, sheet 6, dwelling/family 109, lines 64–73; enumerated 19 Jun 1900 by George A. Gilland. Hans Peterson household. Archive.org reel 786 image n576: https://archive.org/details/12thcensusofpopu786unit/page/n576/mode/1up
- S28: 1910 US Census, Brookville Twp, Redwood Co MN, ED 109 (Sup. Dist. 7), sheet 4A, dwelling/family 61, lines 1–8; enumerated 23 Apr 1910 by Robert Nielsen. Petersen, Hans P. (45, M1 19 yrs, b. Denmark, imm. 1884, Na, farmer, owns farm); Maren S. (37, b. MN, mother of 7 / 7 living); Rudolph H. 16; Anna H. 15; Louis C. 13; Marie E. 11; Ethel M. 8; Elmer H. 4. Archive.org T624 reel 713 image n533: https://archive.org/details/13thcensus1910po713unit/page/n533/mode/1up
- S29: 1920 US Census, Brookville Twp, Redwood Co MN, ED 182, sheet 3B (sheet no. faint), dwelling 54, enumerated 8–10 Jan 1920. Petersen, Hans P. (head, 55, b. Denmark, Danish; owns farm, dairy farmer); Maren S. (47, b. "Denmark" [sic, conflicts with 1900/1910 MN]); Anna H. 25; Ethel M. 17; Elmer H. 13; Olga M. 8. Archive.org T625 reel 851 image n271: https://archive.org/details/14thcensusofpopu851unit/page/n271/mode/1up
- S30: Family confirmation — Alex Petersen, 2026-11-03: "The birth year and location (small town) have to be correct. That's our Hans." Confirms origin Bjernede / b. 1864 (place+year only; not parents).
- S31: Bjernede Hovedministerialbog 1862–, births/baptisms, image 7: Hans Peder Pedersen b. 28 Feb 1864, bapt. 5 Jun 1864, parents (tentative) Hans Pedersen & Ane Rasmusdatter. Arkivalieronline: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538
- S32: Bjernede church book vol. 1858 K–1891 K, confirmations, image 24: Hans Peter Petersen confirmed Palmesøndag 14 Apr 1878; parents Boelsmand Hans Petersen & Ane Rasmusdatter; b. 28 Feb 1864. Arkivalieronline (Rigsarkivet).
- S33: 1880 Danish census, Bjernede sogn, Sorø amt, 1 Feb 1880, image 5/71: Hans Peder Pedersen, 15, stepson in household of Hans Rasmussen & Ane Rasmussen (low-confidence reads). Arkivalieronline (Rigsarkivet).
- S34: Copenhagen Police emigrant protocols (Udvandrerarkivet index), 16 Apr 1884: Hans Peter Petersen, Bjernede Sorø, age 20, dest. Springfield USA, contract 1015 Y: https://www.aalborgstadsarkiv.dk/UA.asp?UA=UAProtokol
- S36: S35 img 99, Copulerede 1862 no. 5: marriage 14 Oct 1862 Bjernede, Ungkarl/Hjulmand Hans Pedersen (b. 25 Feb 1833 Walsmagle?) & Pige Ane Rasmusdatter (b. 17 Jun 1843 Bjernede Lodsgaard?): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 06, 07)
- S37: S35 img 125, Døde Mandkøn 1867 no. 15: Hans Pedersen, hjulmand Bjernedegaardshuse, d. 11 Sep 1867, bur. 17 Sep 1867, age 34, b. 25 Feb 1833, "Søn af Ane

Marie Hans Dat.(?)": https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 10, 10b, 11, 11b)

- S38: S35 img 107, Copulerede 1870 no. 2: spring 1870 (day illegible) Enkemand Hans Rasmussen (b. 19 Apr 1801/1831?, 3rd marriage) & Enke Ane Rasmusdatter (b. 17 Jun 1843, 2nd marriage): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 12, 13)
- S39: S35 img 24, male births 1871 no. 3: Rasmus Peter Rasmussen b. ~1 Mar 1871, parents Hans Rasmussen & Ane Rasmusdatter (27): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 04, 05)
- S40: S35 img 82, female births 1874 no. 11: Ane Marie Rasmussen b. 24 Oct 1874, bapt. 10 Jan 1875, parents Hans Rasmussen & Ane Rasmusdatter (31): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 02, 03)
- S41: S35 img 124, Døde Mandkøn 1867 no. 3: Rasmus Pedersen d. 5 Feb 1867, bur. 10 Feb 1867, son of Hans Pedersen & Ane Rasmusdatter, Bjernedegaardshuse (age read "12 Dage"?): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 08, 09)
- S42: S35 img 5, male births 1863 no. 2: unnamed son b. 17 Jan 1863, parents Hans Pedersen & Ane Rasmusdatter (19), "1st Barn", "Død d. 18de Januar uden Daab(?)" (death remark medium confidence): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 14, 15)
- S43: S35 img 13, male births 1866 no. 17: Rasmus Pedersen b. 10 Dec 1866, bapt. 23 Jan 1867 in church, parents Hjulmand Hans Pedersen & Ane Rasmusdatter (23), Bjernedegaardshuse; margin "† 5/2 67": https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 16, 17)
- S44: 1870 Danish census, Bjernede, Sorø Alsted herred, 1 Feb 1870, img 23 (page 66), "1 Huus": Anne Rasmusen K 27 widow; Hans Peter Pedersen M 6 unmarried: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=53367 (shots 18, 19). NB img 18 Hans Peter Pedersen ~19, servant = namesake, NOT ours.
- S45: Bjernede Hovedministerialbog 1879 FVD–1891 FVD, img 90, Døde Kvindekøn 1883 no. 11: "Ane Marie Rasmussen" d. 29 Jun 1883, bur. 5 Jul 1883, age 40, Gift (2den Gang) med Bolmand Hans Rasmussen i Bjerne Huse. Identity with Ane Rasmusdatter = inference: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots ane-second-family 05, 06)
- S46: same vol., img 71, Døde Mandkøn 1883 no. 4: Hans Rasmussen d. ~2 Jul 1883, bur. 5/8 Jul (days LOW), age 83, Gift (3die Gang), Bolmand i Bjernede Huse, født "Tunnestedt"(? LOW), Faderens Navn Rasmus Hansen: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shots 09, 10)
- S47: Bjernede vol. 1858 K–1891 K, img 33, Drenge spring 1885 no. 5: Rasmus Peter Rasmussen b. 1 Mar 1871 Bjernedehuse, bapt. 4 Apr 1871; parents Bolmand Hans Rasmussen & Ane Rasmussen begge døde; Plejefader Gaardejer Rasmus Rasmussen af Fuldby(?): https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shot 12)

- S48: same K vol., img 80, Piger autumn 1888 no. 6: Ane Marie Rasmussen af Bjernedehuse b. 24 Oct 1874, bapt. 11 Jan 1875; parents begge døde; Plejefader Bolmand Anders Larsen, Bjernedehuse: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/en/billedviser?epid=17223538 (shot 11)
- S50: Sorø By og Birk skøde- og panteprotokol V.V, fol ~328–331, recorded 13 Nov 1884: skøde — estate of afdøde Bolsmand Hans Rasmussen & earlier-deceased Hustru Ane Marie Rasmussen sells Matr. No 5 A af Bjernedehuse, Bjernede Sogn (property "hidtil har tilhørt" Hans Rasmussen) to møller J.P. Mathiesen of Gyrstinge for 13,000 Kr; lease to Indsidder Hans Andersen from 12 Dec 1867 to be honored. Mortgage bond (fol 329/331): 3,600 Kr owed to umyndige Rasmus Peter og Ane Marie Rasmussen, children of afd. Bolsmand Hans Rasmussen og Hustru i Bjernedehusene (= P21, P22). Wife "Ane Marie Rasmussen" = Ane Rasmusdatter (P19) by INFERENCE (as S45). 1855 buyer of 5a (Realregister) = strong candidate same man; vol. T fol 97 not digitized. Matr. 5a as Hans Pedersen (P18) property REJECTED: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=147378 (shots skoede-5a-2026-11-03)
- S51: Haraldsted Sogn, Hovedministerialbog 1814–1845, Fødte Mandkiøn 1833 no. 3, AO epid=17223938 img 58/722: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/38697131 (Hans Pedersen b. 25 Feb 1833, uægte; mother Ane Marie Clausdatter, Valsømagle; udlagt father Peder Johansen, Ringsted) — *Note: display name LOCKED Ane Marie Hansdatter; Clausdatter here is a superseded wrong read (Genealogist 2026-11-03, P25).*
- S52: Haraldsted Sogn, Kontraministerialbog 1814–1842, Fødte Mandkiøn 1833 no. 2, AO bsid=150801 img 65/750: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=150801#150801,25012287 (same event; mother patronymic corrected interlinear "Hansd.")
- S53: Trap Danmark 5. udg., Haraldsted sogn (Valsømagle in Haraldsted sogn): https://trap5.lex.dk/sogn/haraldsted-sogn-ringsted-herred/
- S54: Folketælling 1834, Landdistrikter, Sorø amt, Ringsted herred, Haraldsted sogn, Skee By hh 32 (Jens Nielsen 43 & Kirsten Johansd. 37), "Hans Pedersen, 1, ugift, Pleiebarn", AO bsid=2405 img id 84004: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/84004 (viewer https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=2405)
- S55: Folketælling 1840, Landdistrikter, Haraldsted sogn, Skee By hh 17 (Jens Nielsen 49, Kirsten Johansen 44), "Hans Pedersen, 6, ugift, Pleiebarn", AO bsid=5212 img id 122427 (p. 118): https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/122427
- S56: Haraldsted Sogn, Kontraministerialbog 1841–1861, Confirmerede Drenge 1847 no. 3 (p. 168), AO bsid=150802 img id 25013123: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=150802#150802,25013123 — "Hans Pedersen af Skee … Uægte Søn af Pigen Ane Marie Hansd. og udlagt Barnefader Peder Johansen — Pleiefader Huusm. Jens Nielsen i Skee"; confirmed 11 Apr 1847; b. 25 Feb 1833 i Valsømagle; vacc. 29 Jun 1833 af Aschlund; Fol 41 No 1026

- S57: Folketælling 1845, Landdistrikter, Haraldsted sogn, Skee By hh 99 (Jens Nielsen, Kirsten Johansd. 49), "Hans Pedersen, 12, [født] do. [her i Sognet], Pleiesøn", AO bsid=7005 img id 166828: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/166828

- S58: Folketælling 1850, Landdistrikter, Sorø amt, Ringsted herred, Haraldsted sogn, Skee, "53, et Huus": Jens Nielsen 60 gift Huusmand/Hjulmager(?) Huusfader; Kirsten Johansdatter 53 gift; Hagen Jensen 15 deres Søn; Hans Jensen 6 Pleiebarn. Hans Pedersen (17) NOT in household. AO bsid=113974 img 29/41: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/17265731

- S83 (VERIFIED original — upgrades S34): Københavns Politi (Copenhagen Police), 3. Politiinspektorat, Register over udvandrere. Indirekte (1869–1935), folder 1882–1884, bsid=612215, image 239/301 left page (p. 50), P-section 1884: "Petersen, Hans Peter"; Stilling (occupation) ditto = Tjenende(?) (servant); Fødested/sidste opholdssted (birthplace/last residence) "Bjernede, Sorø"; Alder (age) 20; Bestemmelsessted (destination) "Springfield, Minn."; Kontrakt (contract) 1015 Y; Forevisningsdato (presentation date) 16/4 [1884]. Direct: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/93241070 ; viewer https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?epid=23522257 (folder 1882–1884, image 239). Ship/route NOT in this register. No companions on 1015 Y. Shots: kbhpol-indirekte-1882-84-img239-hans-peter-1015Y.jpg, kbhpol-img239-hans-peter-crop.jpg

- S92 (APPROVED index — P9): MNHS birth — Ethel M. Petersen, b. 15 Jan 1902 Redwood Co; mother Jensen; cert 1902-21163. https://www.mnhs.org/search/people/record?uuid=8b1a886e-e6f0-4c6f-b9a7-d572c7a0f2aa&recordType=birth-records

- S93 (APPROVED index — P10): MNHS birth — Olga Margaret Petersen, b. 28 Feb 1911 Redwood Co; mother Jensen; cert 1911-21964 (middle name Margaret). https://www.mnhs.org/search/people/record?uuid=ba40d979-971d-40a9-9c12-9f86dcbdce87&recordType=birth-records
- S94 (APPROVED index — P3 Elmer): MNHS birth — “Babe” Petersen, b. 24 Mar 1906 Redwood Co; mother Jensen; cert 1906-21514 — date matches Elmer. https://www.mnhs.org/search/people/record?uuid=4735dd80-74a7-405a-b003-e85e45211e63&recordType=birth-records

- S95 (APPROVED index — P8): MNHS death — Rudolph H. Petersen, b. 8 May 1893 MN; mother JENSEN; d. 13 Apr 1964 Hennepin Co; cert 1964-MN-006734. https://www.mnhs.org/search/people/record?uuid=3480d138-4a74-4be4-ba6d-7061b97c2ac5&recordType=death-records

- S271 (APPROVED — HIGH, image-confirmed; Genealogist MN Pack 10): 1920 US Census, Brookville Twp, Redwood Co MN, ED 182, sheet 3B, dwelling 52 / family 54, lines 52–57. Hans P Peterson [P6] 55, b. Denmark, imm 1884, naturalized 1897 (Na); farm owned,

mortgaged (O M); dairy farm, own account (OA). Wife Maren S 47; Anna H 25; Ethel M 17; Elmer H 13; Olga M 8. Nearby same-ED Louis/Carl/Rudolph H. Petersen UNVERIFIED, not linked. S29 remains a valid companion cite (same image). Archive.org reel 851 n271: https://archive.org/details/14thcensusofpopu851unit/page/n271/mode/1up ; FS: https://www.familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:MWBR-VCP

- S272 (APPROVED — HIGH; image-confirmed Pack 10b): Marriage 11 Mar 1891 **at Redwood Falls**, Redwood Co MN — affidavit "Hans Peter Petersen" (license "Hans P. Peterson") × Mary S. Jensen [= P7 Maren Sophia]. Witnesses: Niels Jensen; J. L. Byram (names only; no kinship — Niels Jensen ≠ P7 father, CANDIDATE at most). No ages/parents on form. Officiant not used (given name uncertain). Original viewed: FamilySearch "Redwood. Marriage Records April 1866–May 1894," image 622 of 807, page 58. County: https://www.familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:Q2M5-3J3S ; state: https://www.familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:FD61-GLZ
- S273 (APPROVED — HIGH): 1905 Minnesota state census, Brookville Twp, Redwood Co, p.443 line 80 — Hans P Petersen 41, b. 1864 Denmark; Maren S 32; Niels A 13; Hans R 12; Anna H 10. "Hans R" = Rudolph / 1900 "Hans O." is CANDIDATE only. https://www.familysearch.org/ark:/61903/1:1:SPQ3-3K3
- S274 (APPROVED as conflict restatement only): FamilySearch Minnesota death index (restates MNHS) — Hans T. Petersen, d. 06 Sep 1922, Redwood Co, cert 011514. Cert image unseen. Conflicts with S145 "Hans P."; OPEN, no pick. Date CANDIDATE.

- S145 (APPROVED — newspaper text): Redwood Gazette (Redwood Falls), 1922-09-13, p.4, reprint from Morgan Messenger — Hans P. Petersen, age 55, Brookville Twp ~2 mi east of Brookville church; sudden heart death ~4:30 while sitting in a chair; had been ailing; funeral not yet made; survived by wife + several children (unnamed). Calendar death day NOT proven ("yesterday" relative to Messenger issue). Display name locked Hans P./Hans Peter (Alex/Genealogist); MNHS/FS index Hans T. (S274) conflicts — Alex notes possible typo; conflict OPEN (MN Pack 10 restatement); 1922-09-06 still CANDIDATE; cert image unseen. https://www.loc.gov/resource/sn85025570/1922-09-13/ed-1/?sp=4

- S148 (APPROVED index — P32): MNHS birth — Ethel Bertha Neubauer, b. 1911-11-27 Brown Co; mother's maiden GENT; cert 1911-03110. https://www.mnhs.org/search/people

- S149 (APPROVED index — P32): MNHS death — Ethel B. Dohrmann, d. 1994-06-07 Brown Co; b. 1911-11-27; mother's maiden GENT; cert 1994-MN-015182. https://www.mnhs.org/search/people
- S150 (SECONDARY): Find a Grave 228250641, Ethel B Neubauer Dohrmann, 27 Nov 1911 – 7 Jun 1994, Home Cemetery Sleepy Eye; spouse Wesley (m. 1935). https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/228250641/ethel-b-dohrmann

- S89 (RECORD-SOURCED FAG secondary — Janice's father): Find a Grave 197091387, Wesley Edward Dohrmann, 6 Jun 1902 – 18 Apr 1981, Home Cemetery Sleepy Eye. Bio says

“Married Ethel Gent” — maiden misstated; Gent = Ethel’s mother’s maiden (see S148/S149). https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/197091387/wesley-edward-dohrmann

- S152 (APPROVED — newspaper): Redwood Gazette, 6 Nov 1929, p.5 — “FUNERAL THURSDAY FOR MRS. WERNER JENSEN.” Ethel Mathilda Petersen, b. Brookville Twp 15 Jan 1902; m. Werner Jensen 3 Jan 1923; d. Redwood Falls hospital 20 Oct 1929 after operation; funeral Hans Jensen home Brookville → Brookville Lutheran → church cemetery; Rev. H. Madsen Sleepy Eye. Mother Mrs. Hans Petersen, Olga, Elmer among survivors (cleared). Sister married names Hansen/Strodimier UNVERIFIED — not used. https://www.loc.gov/resource/sn85025570/1929-11-06/ed-1/?sp=5

- S59: Haraldsted Sogn, Kontraministerialbog 1814–1842, Tilgangsliste 1833 no. 199: "Ane Marie Hansd., 28, Tjenestepige", came from Ringsted, dated "d. 30te Marts 1833". AO bsid=150801 img 398: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/25012620

- S60: same KMB, Afgangsliste 1832/33 no. 335: "Ane Marie Hansd., 28, [Tjenestepige] (do.)", moved to Ringsted; date column "do." (ditto), about Nov 1832 to Jan 1833 (LOW). AO bsid=150801 img 475: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/25012697
- S63 (CANDIDATE for P25): Folketælling 1834, Købstæder, Sorø amt, Ringsted købstad, Sankt Hans Gade, AO bsid=4462 img 10/11: "Ane Marie Hansdatter, 27, ugift", in the Tjenestefolk (servants) bracket with Jørgen Jensen 24, just before house No. 304 (Peder Reed 57): https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/112563
- *Note 2026-11-03: S51, S52, S56 support the LOCKED named-father record P34 Peder Johansen of Ringsted (udlagt barnefader; paternity not proven). S64 CLEARED for P34 father bio under Alex Decision B (P28 merged into P34). S63 stays CANDIDATE for P25.*
- S268 (SUPERSEDED — Dig 39): FamilySearch index reading "Peder Jørgensen" as father on the 1833 Haraldsted baptism; mis-index, not a competing father form.
- S275 (CLEARED — Dig 39): AO image of Haraldsted HMB Fødte Mandkiøn 1833 no. 3, father surname letter shapes Joh- not Jørg-; supports P34 Peder Johansen: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/38697131
- S276 (Dig 39 — NOT a mother form): alternate eye-read "Larsdatter" of the baptism parents cell; discarded alongside Clausdatter; P25 Hansdatter lock unchanged.
- S64 (CLEARED — Decision B, P34 bio): same census, Ringsted købstad, Sankt Hans Gade, p. 328, AO bsid=4462 img 1/11: "Peter Johansen, 30, ugift", in the Tjenestefolk (servants) bracket with Hans Sonnesen(?) 39: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/112554
- S106 (UNVERIFIED match MED-HIGH — supports Hansdatter spelling only; NOT identity proof as P18 mother): Ringsted Sogn HMB 1830–1848 (by- og landsogn), Afgangsliste (departure list) 1833 no. 5: "Ane Marie Hansdatter, 28, Tjenestepige" (servant girl), moved to Haraldsted. AO bsid=205354 img 27 (image id 38960693). Fits S59 Haraldsted tilgang 30 Mar 1833 (age 28, from Ringsted). Evidence for Hansdatter form only; does NOT identify her as P18’s mother. Viewer: https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=205354 ; image if available: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/38960693

- S151 (CLEARED for departure — Alex Decision 3, 2026-11-03; read with S59): Haraldsted Sogn, Kontraministerialbog 1814–1842, Afgangsliste (departure list) 1833, entry no. 334 or 335 (number alignment unclear): "Ane Marie Hansd.", 28, occupation ditto under "Tjenestepige" (servant girl); date ditto under "1ste Mai 1833" (c. 1 May 1833). Destination (bestemmelsessted): "Ringsted" (HIGH — Dig 6 crop gate). The "Grøftevandershov(?)" word belongs to the next row (Inger Hansdatter ~15), not Ane Marie. AO bsid=150801 img 475, image id 25012697: https://api.rigsarkivet.dk/ao/v1/images/25012697 ; viewer https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=150801 . About 1 month after S59 tilgang (arrival) 30 Mar 1833 from Ringsted.
- S108 / S157 (NEGATIVE — arrival gap OPEN): Ringsted Sogn HMB bsid=205354, Tilgangsliste (arrival list) 1833 nos 1–81 (incl. May–Oct 1833) and 1834 nos 1–17 searched; no entry for Ane Marie Hansd. from Haraldsted. Her Ringsted arrival after May 1833 is not found; the story names no street or house for it.
- S222 (event/place HIGH; couple → P25 parents CANDIDATE ~60–70%): Haraldsted sogn church book, trolovelse 21 May 1797 at Haraldsted Præstegaarden — Enkemand Hans Pedersen and Pigen Maren Hans D. (Maren Hansdatter), both of Walsøemagle; married 15 Oct 1797. Place card: places/haraldsted-praestegaarden.md (Haraldstedvej 91, 4100 Ringsted; OSM node 341232574).

Encyclopedia sources (K#) — era-context pack, Genealogist-CLEARED 2026-11-03 (fetched 2026-11-03)

- K1 Trap Danmark, "1536-1850 i Ringsted Kommune": https://trap.lex.dk/1536-1850_i_Ringsted_Kommune
- K2 Trap Danmark, "1850-1920 i Ringsted Kommune": https://trap.lex.dk/1850-1920_i_Ringsted_Kommune
- K4 Lex, "Haraldsted" (Steder i middelalderens Danmark): https://lex.dk/Haraldsted
- K5 Lex, "Haraldsted Kirke": https://lex.dk/Haraldsted_Kirke
- K6 Trap Danmark, "Haraldsted Præstegård": https://trap.lex.dk/Haraldsted_Præstegård
- K8 Lex, "Bjernede Kirke": https://lex.dk/Bjernede_Kirke
- K9 Trap Danmark, "Kirker i Sorø Kommune" / "Bjernede Kirke" (search listing): https://trap.lex.dk/.search?query=Bjernede
- K11 Lex, "husmand" (C. Bjørn, P. Grau Møller): https://lex.dk/husmand
- K15 Lex, "Junigrundloven": https://lex.dk/Junigrundloven
- K18 Lex, "stavnsbånd": https://lex.dk/stavnsbånd
- K19 Lex, "konfirmation": https://lex.dk/konfirmation
- K20 Lex, "Skolelovgivningen i Danmark, efter 1521": https://lex.dk/Skolelovgivningen_i_Danmark,_efter_1521
- K22 Trap Danmark, "1850-1920 i Sorø Kommune": https://trap.lex.dk/1850-1920_i_Sorø_Kommune
- K23 Lex, "Krigen i 1864": https://lex.dk/Krigen_i_1864

- K24 Trap Danmark, "1536-1850 i Sorø Kommune": https://trap.lex.dk/1536-1850_i_Sorø_Kommune

MN Pack 11 — Genealogist-CLEARED 2026-11-03

- S278 (HIGH): West Central Tribune obit, Darvin W. Petersen, 4 Jul 2007: https://www.wctrib.com/news/darvin-w-petersen
- S279 (HIGH dates/burial; MED rank): Interment.net MN veterans burials, Darvin W Petersen, Bethany Lutheran Cemetery, Morgan; "US Air Force 1st Lt": https://www.interment.net/united-states/minnesota/veterans-burials/transcription/644.php?page=336
- S280 (HIGH): Nelson-Hillestad obit, Anna Maye (Hansen) Petersen: https://www.nelson-hillestad.com/obituaries/anna-petersen-3
- S281 (HIGH, derived S278+S280): five children of Darvin × Anna Maye — Dwight, Daniel, Diana, Douglas, Deborah.
- S282 (HIGH): Janice E. Jacobsen obit re-fetch (= S1) + KLGR (S4): five sons Randy, Rick, Mike, Chad, Bill; 2025 survivors' residences: https://stephensfuneralservice.com/obituaries/janice-e-jacobsen/779/
- S283 (HIGH): SortedByName MN Death Index, Randy Don Petersen b. 30 Jul 1958, d. 18 Oct 1958 Redwood Co, mother Dohrmann: https://sortedbyname.com/letter_p/petersen/index_591.html
- S284 (NEG — noise): Iowa Darvin Arthur Petersen 1932–2014 ≠ Darvin Wayne; not merged.
- S287 (HIGH): Find a Grave 212639016, Darvin Wayne Petersen, Bethany Lutheran Church Cemetery, Morgan MN.
- S288 (HIGH): Find a Grave 130109756, Anna Maye Petersen, Bethany Lutheran Church Cemetery, Morgan MN; d. 10 May 2014 Pownal, Cumberland Co., Maine.
- S289 (HIGH): Find a Grave 191558269, Randy Don Petersen, Redwood Falls Cemetery (Association); stone "2 1/2 Months".
- S290 (HIGH, index): MNHS death index, Randy Don Petersen, cert 1958-MN-014557; dates corroborated (image not ordered).
- S291 (NEG — noise): not used.

MN Pack 11c — Genealogist-CLEARED 2026-11-03

- S300 (HIGH — state index): MN Official Marriage System (MOMS), Brown County, Certificate C-063: Donald Alvin Petersen × Janice Elaine Dohrmann, m. 14 Sep 1957. https://moms.mn.gov/Search (index only; certified copy not ordered).
- S301 (HIGH — multiple public obits): Janice E. Jacobsen — b. 23 Jul 1938 Sleepy Eye; d. 18 Apr 2025 Garnette Gardens, Redwood Falls; burial Redwood Falls Cemetery; m. Loren Jacobsen 28 Jun 1986 (note only). https://stephensfuneralservice.com/obituaries/janice-e-jacobsen/779/ ; https://www.marshallindependent.com/obituaries/2025/04/janice-

jacobsen/ ; https://www.wctrib.com/obituaries/obits/janice-e-jacobsen-3ubrjenkymyanikmkv0r ; https://www.myklgr.com/obituaries/janice-e-jacobsen/ ; https://www.nujournal.com/obituaries/2025/04/19/janice-jan-e-jacobsen/

- S302 (NEG HIGH): Find a Grave — no Janice memorial under Jacobsen/Petersen/Dohrmann 2025 at Redwood Falls Cemetery (83131) or site-wide Minnesota; no individual grave pin beyond cemetery grounds. https://www.findagrave.com/cemetery/83131/redwood-falls-cemetery-association

Dig J / S310 — Genealogist-CLEARED (thin) 2026-11-03

- S310 (HIGH — event; P26/P27 identity HIGH documentary): Kirke Hvalsø & Særløse kirkebog (HM) 1814–1829, AO bsid=152686 img 114, Copulerede 1818 row 5 — 30 Oct 1818 at Særløse Kirke: Ungkarl Jens Nielsen, 26, *tjenende* near Lejre × Kirsten Johans Datter, 22, *tjenende hos gårdmand* at Tølstrup. Parents none on entry. Kinship of couple to P25/P34 UNVERIFIED — not for bio-parent story. https://arkivalieronline.rigsarkivet.dk/da/billedviser?bsid=152686&page=114